

## **Overcalls**

Because of the Defensive element, the most important requirement for an Overcall is that you have a good suit, one that you'd like partner to lead. Keep in mind:

- a 5-card or longer suit with honor strength

- 9-16 points to overcall at the 1-level

- 11-16 points to overcall at the 2-level

## **Takeout Doubles**

There are three kinds of Takeout Double:

- opening hand strength, no more than 2 of opponent's suit, at least 3 in all other suits
- strong Overcall type, at least 17 points and a good suit. Double, then bid the suit.
- strong Notrump type, 19+ points, stopper in their suit. Double, then bid notrump.

Responding to a Takeout Double

- 0-8 points, bid your best suit as cheaply as possible

- 9-11 points, jump in your best suit

- 12 or more points, cue-bid the opponent's suit

Board: 1

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: North

Lead: ♥9

Board: 2

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: East

Lead: ♣5

Board: 3

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 4♥

Declarer: South

Lead: ♠K

Board: 4

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 4♠

Declarer: West

Lead: ♥Q

**Board 1**

East Deals

None Vul

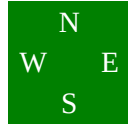
♠ Q 8 3  
 ♥ 6 4 3  
 ♦ 10 8 7 3  
 ♣ 6 5 3

♠ J 7 6

♥ 10 5 2

♦ A J 9 4

♣ K 10 2



♠ K 5 2

♥ A 9 8

♦ K 5 2

♣ J 9 8 7

♠ A 10 9 4

♥ K Q J 7

♦ Q 6

♣ A Q 4

SOUTH has 18 points, a doubleton in the opponent's suit, and at least three cards in the unbid suits. This is an ideal hand for a Takeout Double.

NORTH has good strength in EAST's ♦ suit, probably two stoppers. He has 9 points and no 4-card suit of his own. This is the type of hand to respond 1NT.

SOUTH is happy to play Notrump now that she knows the ♦ s are covered, so she bids 3NT.

| <i>West</i>  | <i>North</i> | <i>East</i> | <i>South</i> |
|--------------|--------------|-------------|--------------|
|              |              | 1 ♦         | Dbl          |
| Pass         | 1NT          | Pass        | 3NT          |
| All Pass     |              |             |              |
| 3NT by North |              |             |              |
| Lead: ♥9     |              |             |              |

**Board 2**

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A K 9 6 4

♥ Q 5

♦ K 7 4

♣ J 10 7

♠ J 3 2

♥ 8 4 3

♦ Q 8 5 3

♣ K 6 2



♠ Q 8

♥ A J 9 2

♦ A J 6

♣ Q 9 8 3

♠ 10 7 5

♥ K 10 7 6

♦ 10 9 2

♣ A 5 4

WEST has an opening hand, 14 points and five ♠s. But SOUTH beat him to the punch, so he overcalls 1 ♠.

EAST also has 14 points, she doesn't care too much for ♠s, but she has an excellent stopper in ♥s. She jumps to 2NT, inviting WEST to bid game.

Since WEST has several points more than he might have had, and no 6-card ♠ suit to rebid, he happily bids 3NT.

*West**North**East**South*

1 ♠

Pass

2NT

1 ♥

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by East

Lead: ♣5

**Board 3**

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K Q 6 2

♥ A 8 2

♦ 9 4 2

♣ 9 3 2

♠ A 9 3

♥ J 10 5 3

♦ Q 5

♣ A K 8 6



♠ J 10 5 4

♥ 6 4

♦ J 10 7 6

♣ 10 7 5

♠ 8 7

♥ K Q 9 7

♦ A K 8 3

♣ Q J 4

SOUTH has 15 points and all the requirements for a Takeout Double of 1♠.

With 14 points of his own, NORTH knows his side needs to be in a game somewhere. He passes this information to SOUTH with a cue-bid of 2♠.

SOUTH gets the message and starts the hunt for a trump fit by bidding 3♥. That makes it easy for NORTH - he bids 4♥.

| West        | North | East | South |
|-------------|-------|------|-------|
|             |       | 1♠   | Dbl   |
| Pass        | 2♠    | Pass | 3♥    |
| Pass        | 4♥    |      |       |
| All Pass    |       |      |       |
| 4♥ by South |       |      |       |
| Lead: ♠K    |       |      |       |

**Board 4**

South Deals

Both Vul

♠ A Q J 6 4 2

♥ A 7

♦ J 7 2

♣ A 8

♠ 8 3

♥ Q J 10 4

♦ A 9 4

♣ K Q 10 5

|   |   |   |
|---|---|---|
|   | N |   |
| W |   | E |
|   | S |   |

♠ K 7 5

♥ 8 5 2

♦ K Q 3

♣ 9 7 6 2

♠ 10 9

♥ K 9 6 3

♦ 10 8 6 5

♣ J 4 3

There is only one reason that WEST should not overcall with 1♠. He is too strong. The maximum strength of an overcall is 16 points. Above that you should double.

So WEST doubles, and after EAST bids 2♣, WEST bids 2♠. This shows an overcall type hand, but with 17 or more points.

EAST has fine trump support and 8 points so she bids a confident 4♠.

| West       | North | East | South |
|------------|-------|------|-------|
|            |       |      | 1♥    |
| Dbl        | Pass  | 2♣   | Pass  |
| 2♠         | Pass  | 4♠   |       |
| All Pass   |       |      |       |
| 4♠ by West |       |      |       |
| Lead: ♥Q   |       |      |       |